rapprochement with the United States after the early 2000s led to an unprecedented focus on democracy, human rights, and pluralism as "shared values."[56] As the first Indian Prime Minister to visit a World War I memorial in France (2015) and the Arlington National Cemetery in the United States (2016), Narendra Modi also contributed to reviving the narrative of India as a leading liberal power driven by "the ideals of freedom and democracy" and that "our belief in democracy for our nations and liberty for our countrymen is common."[57]

Second, in the face of rising Chinese capabilities, India has also adopted a more liberal language in a variety of responses to new security issues, which casts its democratic credentials as an alleged advantage to ensure a more inclusive, multilateral, and rules-based order. Whether on China's Belt and Road Initiative for Eurasian strategic connectivity, freedom of navigation and maritime security, or an open Internet and cybersecurity, New Delhi has emphasised an alternative vision based on existing institutions and principles that underpin the liberal order rather than supporting Beijing's revisionist moves.[58]

Finally, and most importantly, India has upgraded its technical capacity to support democratisation processes, especially in its immediate neighbour-hood. As underlined by Manmohan Singh in 2004, "we should not shy away from opportunities to strengthen the institutions of democratic pluralism whenever we are called upon to do so."[59] For example, under the Bureau of Parliamentary Studies and Training (BPST), the Indian parliament has hosted and trained more than 6000 foreign parliament officials since 1986. Recently expanded and renamed the Parliamentary Research and Training Institute for Democracies (PRIDE), its programmes focus increasingly on officials from neighbouring countries in particular from Afghanistan, Nepal, and Myanmar.[60] Between 2011 and 2017, the